FREE CHECKLIST · VA 101 EP 31

Inbox and Calendar Management

The core skill of an executive assistant. A calm inbox and a calendar with no surprises.

Label	What goes here
1-Urgent	Needs a reply today
2-Waiting reply	You replied, waiting on someone
Clients	Client and lead emails
Invoices	Bills, receipts, payments
Newsletters	Auto-filtered, read later

Filters to set up first

- ☐ Newsletters and promos skip the inbox and go to Newsletters
- ☐ Invoices and receipts go to Invoices
- ☐ VIP senders (the client, their boss) get a star
- ☐ Calendar invites go to Clients

Daily inbox routine (3 checks a day)

- ☐ Start of shift: sort everything, flag urgent
- ☐ Midday: reply, archive what is done
- ☐ End of shift: inbox near zero, list what needs the client in your EOD

Agree with your client first what you can reply to on your own, and what needs their OK.

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Calendar rules

Most scheduling mistakes are time zone mistakes.

Before you book

☐ Check the time zone of everyone in the meeting
☐ Use a meeting planner (for example timeanddate.com)
☐ Leave a 15-minute buffer between calls
☐ Protect focus time and lunch on the client calendar
☐ Add the meeting link and agenda to the invite

After you book

☐ Send a confirmation with the time in their time zone
☐ Reminder the day before
☐ If someone cancels, offer 2 new slots right away

BOOKING MESSAGE

Hi James, Sarah can meet on Tue 18 Nov at 10:00 AM Sydney time (7:00 AM Philippine time). Here is the link: [link]. Does that work for you?

Tip: in Google Calendar you can show a second time zone so you always see the client's time.